

For watch collectors and aficionados, it couldn't be a better time to splurge on some classy watches. Following the pandemic-induced upheaval around the world, the global luxury watch market—which is expected to grow to \$33.07 billion by FY26 from \$27.19 billion in FY21, per a report by The Business Research Company—is ticking back to life again. As the young generation embraces the passion of collecting watches, and actually wears them not with staid grey suits as was the tradition earlier, but with polo T-shirts and sneakers, watchmakers are also letting go of their sombre image and launching trendy watches to keep up with the changing times. Here are a chosen few that you may consider for your wrist.



JACOB & CO. ASTRONOMIA SOLAR BITCOIN

WHERE TO ENQUIRE www.jacobandco.com
PRICE \$350,000

► **Cryptocurrency** may have lost the halo around it but storied watchmaker Jacob & Co.'s latest Astronomia collection watch is inspired by the astronomical valuations that Bitcoin achieved a while ago. Replete with a yellow sapphire sun, a one-carat diamond moon and a golden Earth, the watch's dial also carries a miniature black rocket and a rotating Bitcoin logo that reaches for the moon. The black titanium watch's movement is surrounded by an engraving that reads "peer to peer," "block-chain" and "decentralised digital currency". Limited to only 25 pieces, the watch is meant for true-blue crypto kings.



PATEK PHILIPPE 5270P-014

WHERE TO ENQUIRE www.patek.com
PRICE ON REQUEST

► **Launched in 2011**, the latest Reference 5270 is heir to several generations of the Patek Philippe calendar chronographs and reinterprets their design in an iconic yet original style. No longer the conservative high-end watchmaker—although the brand's watches still have top-notch craftsmanship and a design language to match its legacy—its clientele has evolved dramatically over the years. And catering to this young and vibrant crowd is a playful emerald green dial coupled with alligator straps. That being said, the fundamentals of the 5270—its heart, so to say—are intact. As such, the watch retains the typical 950-platinum case of 41 mm, with a concave bezel and slender and elongated stepped lugs. Love it or hate it, this is a collector's item that will make its admirers green with envy.

